



ROSE, from left, Emily and Emma take a selfie in the “Sliving” lounge of Altadena Girls’ facility in Pasadena.

JUDGE ORDERS TROOPS’ REMOVAL IN L.A.

Trump doesn’t hold ‘unchecked power’ to control National Guard, ruling says.

By SONJA SHARP AND JOSEPH SERNA

A federal judge ruled Wednesday that the Trump administration must immediately end the deployment of the National Guard in Los Angeles, the latest legal blow to the president’s embattled efforts to police American streets with armed troops.

Senior U.S. District Judge Charles R. Breyer said in his ruling that command of the remaining 300 federalized National Guard troops must return to Gov. Gavin Newsom, who sued the administration in June after it commandeered thousands of troops to quell protests over immigration enforcement in Los Angeles.

On June 12, Breyer ruled that deployment illegal — a decision that was ultimately reversed by the U.S. 9th Circuit Court of Appeals. The court said the esoteric statute Trump invoked to wrest command of the Guard from the governor afforded him “a great level of deference” to determine whether a rebellion was underway in Los Angeles, as the Justice Department claimed at the time.

[See [Guard](#), A7]

Will Altadena Girls remain a success story?

Teen-founded charity tries to keep mission alive

By AUGUST BROWN

The s’more bar was finally bubbling at Altadena Girls’ new community space.

A few dozen teen and tween girls, all affected by the wildfires that had ripped their town apart in January, came together for a “cozy cabin” hangout night in downtown Pasadena — some making Christmas ornaments while others applied glittery makeup and temporary tattoos or kicked back on overstuffed furniture.

Avery Colvert, who founded Altadena Girls in January as a 14-year-old, hung garlands and decorations around the 12,000-square-foot complex, beaming that what she’d built was at last open to the world.

The nonprofit was still gussying up the podcast studios, rock band rehearsal rooms and the basement “Sliving” lounge — a young content creators’ paradise decorated by Paris Hilton, who coined

the term referring to living your best life.

“We have a video of Avery touring the space at the very beginning, and she was talking about what she imagined would be in each room,” her mother, Lauren Sandidge, said at the event last month. “To be sitting here, and now most of the things that we were just riffing on are reality, it’s a pretty amazing feeling.”

Of all the charities that emerged in the chaos and triage of January’s fires, none captured popular attention like Altadena Girls. Avery organized her community to raise donations of clothing, hygiene kits and other essentials (and life-affirming pleasures) that displaced teen girls needed — over a million items in all. Altadena Girls became a social media sensation and a celebrity-beloved cause.

As the community nears the anniversary of the fires, Altadena Girls’ flagship project has finally [See [Altadena](#), A14]

Trump softens his stance on China

Security strategy and chip sales recast U.S. global interests in business terms.

By MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — President Trump last week released a national security strategy laying out his vision for America’s role in the world, tempering U.S. support for long-standing allies and recasting U.S. global interests in business terms.

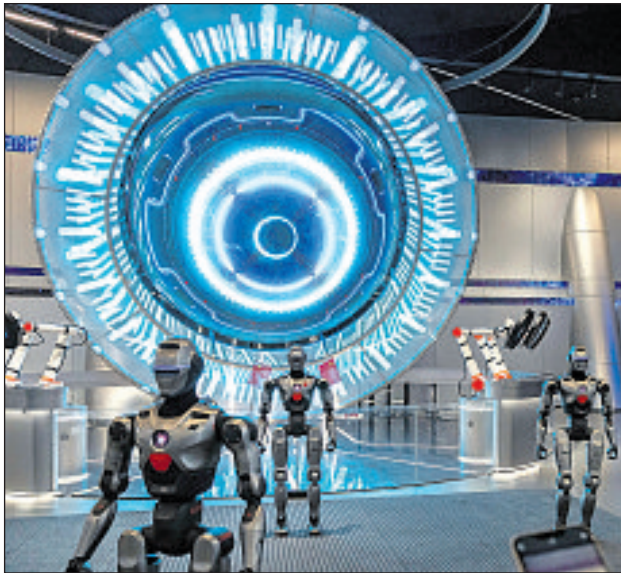
China took note. The paper’s section on Asia, almost entirely devoted to China and the threat of war over Taiwan, concludes with an imperative to win “economic and

technological competition” in the Indo-Pacific.

But the document offers no strategic plan on how to bolster U.S. alliances and an infrastructural base unprepared for a war this decade. And it never once mentions the race against China for superiority in artificial intelligence.

Three days after releasing the document, Trump announced that Nvidia, the world’s most valuable company and leading chipmaker, could begin selling powerful chips to China — the kind of chips key to powering AI. Trump’s move broke with decades of U.S. export control policy he once supported.

It was a welcome series of events in Beijing, where Chi- [See [China](#), A6]



QILAI SHEN Bloomberg

THE U.S. document fails to mention the AI race with China. Above, robots at a museum in Shenzhen.

Fed cuts rate but signals restraint

Central bank says it may hold steady in the coming months, possibly irking Trump.

By CHRISTOPHER RUGABER

The Federal Reserve reduced its key interest rate for the third time in a row Wednesday but signaled that it may leave rates unchanged in the coming months, a move that could attract ire from President Trump, who has demanded steep reductions to borrowing costs.

In a statement released after a two-day meeting, the Fed’s rate-setting committee signaled that it may keep its rate unchanged in the coming months. And in a set of quarterly economic projections, Fed officials signaled they expect to lower rates just once next year.

Wednesday’s cut reduced the rate by a quarter-point to about 3.6%, the lowest it has been in nearly three years. Lower rates from the Fed can bring down borrowing costs for mortgages, auto loans and credit cards over time, though market forces can also affect those rates.

Three Fed officials dissented from the move, the most in six years and a sign of deep divisions on a committee that traditionally works by consensus. Two officials voted to keep the Fed’s rate unchanged, while Stephen Miran, whom Trump appointed in September, voted for a half-point cut.

December’s meeting [See [Rates](#), A11]

For autism causes, experts look to genes, not vaccines

By CORINNE PURTILL

Earlier this year, Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. pledged that the search for autism’s cause — a question that has kept researchers busy for the better part of six decades — would be over in just five months.

“By September, we will know what has caused the autism epidemic, and we’ll be able to eliminate those exposures,” Kennedy told President Trump during a Cabinet meeting in April.

That ambitious deadline has come and gone. But researchers and advocates say that Kennedy’s continued fixation on autism’s origins — and his frequent, inaccurate claims that childhood vaccines are somehow involved — is built on fundamental misunderstandings

of the complex neurodevelopmental condition.

Even after more than half a century of research, no one yet knows exactly why some people have autistic traits and others do not, or why autism spectrum disorder looks so different across the people who have it. But a few key themes have emerged.

Researchers believe that autism is most likely the result of a complex set of interactions between genes and the environment that unfold while a child is in the womb. It can be passed down through families, or originate with a spontaneous gene mutation.

Environmental influences may indeed play a role in some autism cases, but their effect is heavily influenced by a person’s genes. There is no evidence for a single trigger that causes autism, and certainly not

FBI is directed to list ‘domestic terrorists’ in U.S.

Justice Department memo calls for cash rewards for people who report on others.

By MICHAEL WILNER AND ANA CEBALLOS

WASHINGTON — Justice Department leadership has directed the FBI to “compile a list of groups or entities engaged in acts that may constitute domestic terrorism” by the start of next year, and to establish a “cash reward system” that incentivizes individuals to report on their fellow Americans, according to a memo reviewed by The Times.

Law enforcement agencies are directed in the memo, dated Dec. 4, to identify “domestic terrorists” who use violence, or the threat of violence, to advance political and social agendas, including “adherence to radical gender ideology, anti-Americanism, anti-capitalism, or anti-Christianity.”

Although the memo does not mention protests against President Trump’s immigration crackdown directly, it says that problematic “political and social agendas” could include “opposition to law and immigration enforcement, extreme views in favor of mass migration and open borders.”

The memo, sent by Atty. Gen. Pam Bondi to federal prosecutors and law enforcement agencies, follows on a presidential memorandum signed by Trump in the immediate aftermath of the killing of Charlie Kirk, a prominent conservative figure, that gave civil rights groups pause over the potential targeting of political activists, donors and non-

profits opposed to the president.

The memo also outlines what it says are causes of domestic terrorist activity, including “hostility towards traditional views on family, religion, and morality.”

“Federal law enforcement will prioritize this threat. Where federal crime is encountered, federal agents will act,” the memo states.

Some national security experts said the memo represents a dramatic operational shift, by directing federal prosecutors and agents to approach domestic terrorism in a way that is “ideologically one-sided.” At worst, critics said, the memo provides legal justification for criminalizing free speech.

“I think this causes a chilling impact, because it definitely seems to be directing enforcement toward particular points of view,” Mary McCord, a former acting U.S. assistant attorney general for national security, said in an interview.

The memo, for example, primarily focuses on antifaligned extremism, but omits other trends that in recent years have been identified as rising domestic threats, such as violent white supremacy. Since Trump resumed office, the FBI has cut its office designated to focus on domestic extremism, withdrawing resources from investigations into white supremacists and right-wing antigovernment groups.

The memo’s push to collect intelligence on antifa through internal lists and public tip lines also raised questions over the scope of the investigative mission, and how wide a net investigators might cast.

“Whether you’re going to [See [Justice](#), A6]



FEDERICO PARRA AFP/Getty Images

U.S.-VENEZUELA TENSION

Venezuelans rally in support of President Nicolás Maduro in Caracas. The U.S. has seized an oil tanker off that country’s coast. **NATION**, A4

Struggling with affordability

Trump dismisses the high cost of living, but it’s a real concern for many folks, Steve Lopez writes. **CALIFORNIA**, B1

Weather

Sunny and very warm. L.A. Basin: 80/50. **B6**

Markets **A11**
Opinion Voices **A12**

Security issues in Paramount bid

Mideast royal families would put \$24 billion in the offer for Warner. **BUSINESS**, A9

For the latest news, go to [latimes.com](#).



7 85944 00200 5